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# april 3 ballot - Women figuring large in L.A.-area special elections

February 11, 2018 | Los Angeles Daily News (CA)
Author: Kevin Modesti | Section: News | 268 Words
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In what many expect to be a political Year of the Woman, female candidates loom prominently in all three special elections to fill vacant California Assembly seats in Los Angeles County.

Eight women are among 20 candidates — a higher-than-usual proportion for local legislative races — who met the Thursdaydeadline to enter the April 3 special-election primaries, two of which are forced by the resignations of assemblymen accused of sexual harassment.

The candidate lists are expected to be certified by the secretary of state's office.

In Assembly District 39, in the north San Fernando Valley, six candidates seek to replace Democrat Raul Bocanegra, who resigned in November: Democrats Patty Lopez, the former assemblywoman, Luz Rivas, Antonio Sanchez, Yolie Anguiano and Patrea Patrick and Republican Ricardo Benitez.

In Assembly District 45, covering the west San Fernando Valley, nine are hoping to replace Democrat Matt Dababneh, who resigned in December: independent Dennis Zine, the area's former L.A. city councilman, Democrats Jesse Gabriel, Tricia Robbins Kasson, Ankur Patel, C.R. Cochrane, Daniel Brin, Ray Bishop and Jeff Bornstein and Republican Justin Clark.

In Assembly District 54, in L.A., five want to replace Democrat Sebastian Ridley-Thomas, who cited health problems when he resigned in December: Democrats Sydney Kamlager, an L.A. Community College District trustee, Tepring Piquado, Steve Dunwoody and Grayson Pangilinan and Republican Glen Ratcliff.

Unless a candidate gets an outright majority April 3, the top two-vote getters will advance to a runoff June 5, and the winner will serve until Dec. 3. June 5 also is the day of the primaries for the next two-year terms; the general election is Nov. 6.

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- **Citation (apa Style)**
  Modesti, K. (2018, February 11). april 3 ballot Women figuring large in L.A.-area special elections. *Daily News of Los Angeles (CA)*, p. 3. Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/16A007031617AF78.